BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL | MIDDLE MARKET

QUARTERLY INDUSTRY REPORT | Q4 2026

CONSUMER

Strategic and financial buyers stayed active across consumer through the third quarter, and they are paying for brands and operators that have held price and volume while the cost of financing a purchase rises.

- Food & Beverage
- Consumer Brands & Products
- Foodservice & Distribution
- Consumer Services & Retail

October 2026 | Jared Hardin, Managing Director

WHAT'S INCLUDED

01 **Insights**
What is happening now, three repriced costs, four segments, our view, and what we are reading

02 **Sector Activity**
Transactions, buyers, public company performance, operating metrics, and earnings commentary

03 **About Benchmark**
Benchmark and the Middle Market team

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Our Team

The Middle Market team leads each engagement from the first conversation through signing and closing.

Middle Market

The Middle Market team represents owners of privately held companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value in strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions.

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CONSUMER COVERAGE

- Food & Beverage
- Consumer Brands & Products
- Foodservice & Distribution
- Consumer Services & Retail

Benchmark International Middle Market team as of October 2026.

01

Insights

Buyers of consumer businesses stayed active through the third quarter while rebuilding what they treat as normal earnings after a year of changes in tariffs, fuel prices, and interest rates. Brands that held volume through price increases, companies that sell through more than one channel and operators with room to add locations drew the strongest bids.

05 Happening in consumer right now

06 Tariffs, fuel, and financing: three costs buyers are repricing

07 Perspectives on four consumer segments

08 Our view

09 What we're reading



Happening in Consumer Right Now

Four developments shaping the consumer market in the third quarter, with management commentary on page 20.



WHAT IT MEANS FOR OWNERS

Buyers are paying for brands and operators that have held price and volume, that sell through more than one channel, and that have room to add distribution or locations.

An owner who can show price increases by product or service line, with unit volume, and customer retention beside them, gives a buyer the evidence that supports a higher valuation.

23.8%

Brands are being sorted by whether volume follows price

Hershey's organic sales rose 3.6% in the second quarter on about 12 points of price and an 8-point decline in volume, while Church & Dwight grew organic sales 5.8% with volume up 4.3% (Hershey; Church & Dwight). General Mills reported flat organic sales with volume down a point, and store brands reached a record 23.8% of units sold in the first half (General Mills; PLMA).

READ-THROUGH

Buyers pay for brands that hold unit volume while they raise price.

17.1%

Growth is arriving through more than one channel

E-commerce reached $340.2 billion in the second quarter, or 17.1% of retail sales, and Walmart's global e-commerce sales grew 23% in its July quarter (Census Bureau; Walmart). YETI grew wholesale sales 10% and direct-to-consumer sales 7% in its second quarter, and General Mills' foodservice business grew organic sales 4% while the company's total organic sales were flat (YETI; General Mills).

READ-THROUGH

Buyers credit companies that sell through wholesale, direct-to-consumer, and foodservice rather than through one channel.

$120B

Strategic acquirers are reshaping portfolios at scale

Kimberly-Clark, McCormick, and Sysco have committed more than $120 billion to three transactions since November 2025 (Kenvue; Unilever's food business; Jetro Restaurant Depot). The largest companies are also selling and separating businesses: General Mills completed the sale of its Brazil business on September 2, Keurig Dr Pepper is preparing to separate in early 2027, and Middleby spun off its food processing business in July (General Mills; Keurig Dr Pepper; Middleby).

READ-THROUGH

Large companies are selling slower businesses and buying growth and capacity from smaller companies.

3 in 4

Multi-site platforms keep adding locations

Add-on acquisitions made up about three-quarters of US private equity buyouts in the second quarter (PitchBook). Boyd Group's second-quarter sales rose 29.9%, mostly from new locations that include the 258 Joe Hudson's collision centers it bought in January, Tidal Wave Auto Spa reached 332 car wash locations in September, and SPS PoolCare had completed 191 acquisitions since 2021 by January (Boyd Group; Tidal Wave Auto Spa; SPS PoolCare).

READ-THROUGH

Add-ons made up about three-quarters of private equity buyouts, so owners with locations or routes a platform can absorb draw the most interest.

Company figures are from quarterly earnings releases filed between July 30 and October 1, 2026. Store brand share is Circana data for the six months to June 14, 2026. Platform location and acquisition counts are from the linked announcements.

Tariffs, Fuel, and Financing: Three Costs Buyers Are Repricing

Tariffs, fuel, and interest rates moved in the past year, and the moves change what a buyer will treat as normal earnings.

A consumer company that reaches the market in the next year will present earnings that passed through three tariff regimes, a fuel shock, and the first increase in the federal funds rate since 2023. Buyers are rebuilding each of those costs period by period before they settle on the earnings they will pay for.

The effect differs from one company to the next. YETI recorded a $45.6 million net benefit from tariff refunds in its second quarter and Walmart said it reinvested its refunds into price, while 91% of the foodservice equipment manufacturers surveyed by their trade association reported negative effects from tariffs and 78% said they were passing the cost on to customers.

> ***An owner who can hand a buyer landed cost by period, fuel recovery by contract, and a clear account of how the business is financed shortens diligence and protects the earnings figure the price is built on.***

WHAT BUYERS ARE REBUILDING

01 Tariffs

The Supreme Court held on February 20 that the International Emergency Economic Powers Act does not authorize tariffs, a temporary 10% tariff followed, and since July 24 Section 301 tariffs of 10% to 12.5% apply to 60 trading partners. Section 232 duties stayed in place, including 25% on upholstered furniture, and duty-free treatment for parcels under $800 remains suspended.

WHAT BUYERS ASK FOR Landed cost under each regime, the status of any refund claim, and the sourcing alternatives the company has already qualified.

02 Fuel

On-highway diesel averaged $6.29 a gallon in September against $3.75 a year earlier (FRED). The Energy Information Administration's October outlook expects retail diesel to average about $4.50 next year, which would still be well above the price distributors and route-based service companies paid a year ago.

WHAT BUYERS ASK FOR Which customer contracts carry fuel surcharges or cost escalators, how quickly they reset, and how much of the increase the company has recovered.

03 Financing

The Federal Reserve raised its target range to 3.75% to 4.00% in September and projects a policy rate of 4.1% at the end of 2026 and 2027. Spreads on new direct loans to middle-market buyouts widened by roughly 25 basis points in the second quarter, and earn-outs appeared in 24% of 2025 transactions with a median equal to 34% of the closing payment (SRS Acquiom study, as summarized by Fasken).

WHAT BUYERS ASK FOR How much of the price is paid in cash at closing, how much is contingent, and how much is rolled into the buyer's equity.



THE REPRICING IN FOUR FIGURES

12.5%
Section 301 tariff on goods from China and Vietnam since July 24

$6.29
Diesel per gallon, September average, against $3.75 a year earlier

3.75% to 4.00%
Federal funds target range after the September 16 increase

24%
Share of 2025 transactions that included an earn-out

A higher rate lowers the debt a sponsor can place against the same earnings, so price support shifts toward strategic buyers that fund purchases from cash flow.

Tariff rates are as described in the linked sources. Diesel is the monthly average US on-highway retail price published by the Energy Information Administration. Earn-out figures are from the SRS Acquiom 2026 deal terms study of 2025 transactions, and the loan spread figure is from Northleaf Capital Partners' second-quarter private credit update.

Perspectives on Four Consumer Segments

What is moving demand, and who is buying, in each of the segments the consumer practice covers.



Food & Beverage

23.8% Store brand share of units sold in the first half of 2026

- The largest packaged food companies report flat or falling volume, and they are selling slow brands and buying growth and capacity from smaller companies (General Mills; Conagra).
- Growth is in protein, zero-sugar beverages, supplements, and foodservice, and Procter & Gamble agreed to buy Thorne in a deal reportedly valued at $3.8 billion.
- National distributors are growing case volume with independent restaurants, up 5.1% at US Foods and 5.8% organically at Performance Food Group .

WHO IS BUYING

Family-owned strategics such as Rich Products, Sargento, and C.H. Guenther, bakery consolidators, private equity platforms, and European strategics entering the United States.

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL

4 closed since January 2025



Consumer Brands & Products

7% Growth in both prestige and mass beauty sales in the first half of 2026

- Beauty, personal care, over-the-counter health, and pet products drew a large share of this year's brand acquisitions, and beauty and pet spending are still growing (Circana; American Pet Products Association).
- Dollar growth overstates unit demand: non-edible packaged goods rose 3.1% in dollars and fell 2.2% in units in the five weeks to July 4 (Circana).
- Importers have carried three tariff regimes since April 2025, and packaging producer-responsibility rules took effect in California on May 1.

WHO IS BUYING

Strategics such as Procter & Gamble, Clorox, and Henkel, consumer private equity firms such as Advent, TSG, and TowerBrook, and brand-management firms.

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL

2 closed since January 2025



Foodservice & Distribution

$1.55T Restaurant and foodservice sales forecast for 2026

- Operators are spending carefully: sales of equipment and supplies through manufacturers' agents rose 2.0% in the second quarter, and the share of agents reporting more quoting fell to 33%.
- Franchisee distress is the credit risk in the channel. A 314-unit Wendy's franchisee filed for Chapter 11 in September after store-level EBITDA fell 48%.
- Parts Town and Easy Ice kept buying repair and ice-machine businesses through the year.

WHO IS BUYING

Strategic dealers such as Singer and Wasserstrom, parts and service platforms such as Parts Town and Tech24, and route platforms such as Five Star Breaktime Solutions.

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL

6 closed since January 2025



Consumer Services & Retail

$3.1B Enterprise value of the Mister Car Wash take-private completed in May

- Sponsors paid for scale: Leonard Green took Mister Car Wash private and Blackstone agreed to buy a majority stake in Champions Group in a deal reported at about $2.5 billion.
- Platforms buy family-owned operators a few locations at a time, as when Classic Collision bought Kendrick Paint & Body, a nine-location family business, in December.
- Housing-linked demand softened through the summer, and growth in home improvement spending is projected to slow to 0.5% by the second quarter of 2027.

WHO IS BUYING

Sponsor-backed platforms in car wash, collision, roofing, pool, and garage door service, public acquirers such as Rollins and Boyd Group, and regional strategics.

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL

20 closed since January 2025

Benchmark International counts are from the firm's transaction records as of October 1, 2026. Store brand share is from the Private Label Manufacturers Association, the restaurant sales forecast from the National Restaurant Association and beauty sales from Circana.

Our View

Buyers are paying for brands and operators that held volume, sell through more than one channel, and can add locations.

OUR POSITION

Buyers are paying for brands and operators that held volume while they raised price, that sell through more than one channel, and that can add locations, and with financing costs higher they are testing the earnings behind that performance more closely than a year ago.

23.8%

store brand share of units sold in the first half of 2026 (Private Label Manufacturers Association)

About 75%

of US private equity buyouts in the second quarter were add-on acquisitions (PitchBook)

9 of 17

named acquirers of our consumer clients were operating companies or platforms adding to an existing business

SEGMENT	DEMAND	OUR VIEW
FOOD & BEVERAGE	MIXED ●●○○	Buyers are separating brands that hold volume from brands that rely on price. Hershey's organic sales rose 3.6% on about 12 points of price against an 8-point volume decline, store brands reached 23.8% of units, and packaged food companies trade at a median 8.8x EBITDA against 9.8x a year ago. Strategics still pay for growth categories, as Hormel did at 10.7x for Brakebush Brothers.
CONSUMER BRANDS & PRODUCTS	STEADY ●●●○	Beauty, personal care, over-the-counter health, and pet products drew a large share of this year's brand acquisitions, and household and personal care companies trade at a median 17.1x EBITDA against 16.3x a year ago. Dollar growth runs ahead of unit demand, with non-edible packaged goods up 3.1% in dollars and down 2.2% in units, so buyers will test unit trends and tariff exposure by product.
FOODSERVICE & DISTRIBUTION	STEADY ●●●○	Foodservice distribution companies trade at a median 13.6x EBITDA, level with a year ago, and Sysco agreed to pay 14.6x operating income for Jetro Restaurant Depot. Operators are spending carefully, with the share of manufacturers' agents reporting more quoting down to 33%, and a 314-unit Wendy's franchisee in Chapter 11 shows where credit risk sits.
CONSUMER SERVICES & RETAIL	STRONG ●●●●	Sponsors and public acquirers keep paying for scale and recurring customers: Leonard Green paid $3.1 billion for Mister Car Wash, Oak Hill agreed to buy Guild Garage Group at a reported 16x EBITDA, and Rollins allocated about 89% of its Romex price to customer contracts and goodwill. Consumer services shares are down 33.3% in a year and the median multiple is 11.9x against 18.2x a year ago.

OUR ADVICE TO OWNERS

1. Show price, volume, and customer retention by product or service line, because buyers separate growth that comes from units from growth that comes from price.
2. Assemble landed cost by period, fuel recovery by contract, and the financing terms of the business before a process, since buyers are rebuilding earnings from those three costs.
3. Approach operating companies and platforms in adjacent categories alongside sponsors; nine of the 17 named acquirers of our consumer clients were operating companies or platforms.

Views are those of the Benchmark International Middle Market team, drawn from the figures in this report, which are the latest published as of October 19, 2026. Demand reflects the team's assessment for owner-operated businesses in each segment.

What We're Reading

Primary sources and industry releases from the third quarter.



Four pieces from the quarter

Four releases from the quarter that speak to how consumer businesses are valued and sold.

USDA ECONOMIC RESEARCH SERVICE — September 25, 2026

Food Price Outlook: Summary Findings

> *"In 2026, prices for all food are forecast to increase 2.9 percent, with a forecast interval of 2.5 to 3.2 percent."*
>
> USDA Economic Research Service, Food Price Outlook

Key takeaway. Food-at-home prices are forecast to rise 2.4% and food-away-from-home prices 3.5%, with beef and veal up 9.4% and eggs down 29.4%. Input costs are moving in different directions by category, which is why buyers ask for price and cost history by product line.

READ HERE

PRIVATE LABEL MANUFACTURERS ASSOCIATION — July 8, 2026

Store Brands Continue Gains in Unit Sales and Shares

> *"The disconnect between unit sales and dollar sales reflects, in part, fluctuating national brand pricing."*
>
> Peggy Davies, President, Private Label Manufacturers Association

Key takeaway. Store brand unit share reached a record 23.8% in the six months to mid-June, while store brand dollar sales were flat and national brand dollars rose 2.2%. Buyers pay for brands that hold unit volume while they raise price.

READ HERE

NATIONAL RESTAURANT ASSOCIATION — September 30, 2026

Restaurant Performance Index: August 2026

> *"The National Restaurant Association's Restaurant Performance Index (RPI) rose for the fourth consecutive month in August, largely because of improvements in both same-store sales and customer traffi c levels."*
>
> National Restaurant Association, Restaurant Performance Index

Key takeaway. The index stood at 100.6, with 51% of operators reporting higher same-store sales than a year earlier and 46% still reporting lower traffic. Distributors and equipment dealers that sell to restaurants are valued partly on the health of those customers.

READ HERE

DELOITTE — September 10, 2026

Deloitte Forecasts Holiday Retail Sales to Reach $1.70 Trillion to $1.71 Trillion

> *"As they look to get more out of their dollars, we continue to see value-seeking behaviors across income levels, including switching among brands and retailers and using promotions to manage spending."*
>
> Natalie Martini, vice chair, Deloitte, and US retail and consumer products leader

Key takeaway. Holiday sales are forecast to rise 4.0% to 4.8% and e-commerce sales 7.5% to 8.4%. Online sales growing at nearly twice the pace of the total keeps channel mix in front of every buyer of a consumer brand.

READ HERE

Quotations are reproduced as published. Store brand figures are Circana data for the six months ending June 14, 2026. The Deloitte forecast covers November 2026 through January 2027.

02

Sector Activity

Strategic acquirers have committed more than $120 billion to three consumer transactions since November 2025, and sponsor-backed platforms are buying family-owned operators a few locations at a time. Listed consumer companies trade at lower multiples of earnings than a year ago in seven of the nine peer groups we track.

11 Select recent consumer transactions

14 Benchmark International's consumer transactions

15 Landscape: select participants

16 Public company performance and valuation

24 Demand and cost indicators



Select Recent Consumer Transactions

Acquirers disclosed a price in most of these transactions and a multiple of earnings in only a few.

ANNOUNCED	TARGET AND ACQUIRER	BUSINESS AND TERMS	STATED VALUE	VALUE TO REVENUE	VALUE TO EARNINGS
SEPT 2026 FOOD & BEVERAGE	Brakebush ACQUIRED BY Hormel Foods	Hormel agreed on September 30 to acquire Brakebush Brothers, a Wisconsin producer of prepared chicken with about $1.2 billion of net sales in the latest twelve months (Hormel and Brakebush Brothers).	About $1.06B	About 0.9x calculated from the stated figures	10.7x projected CY2026 adjusted EBITDA, as stated by Hormel
WHAT IT SHOWS Hormel paid 10.7x projected 2026 adjusted EBITDA for a prepared chicken producer, against a median of 8.8x for listed packaged food companies.					
JULY 2026 FOOD & BEVERAGE	ACQUIRED BY HFFoods	HF Foods agreed in July to acquire Searay Foods, a British Columbia distributor of frozen specialty seafood, completed the purchase on September 3 and stated the base price as a multiple of 2025 adjusted EBITDA (HF Foods and Searay Foods).	C$47.9M	Not disclosed	5.0x 2025 adjusted EBITDA on the base price, as stated by HF Foods
WHAT IT SHOWS A frozen seafood distributor sold at 5.0x adjusted EBITDA, the lowest multiple in this table.					
JULY 2026 FOOD & BEVERAGE	COPRA COCONUTS ACQUIRED BY	Vita Coco acquired Copra, a privately held producer of super-premium Thai coconut water sold chilled and frozen, for $175 million at closing plus an earn-out of $45 million to $100 million payable in 2029 (Vita Coco and Copra).	$175M	Not disclosed	Not disclosed
WHAT IT SHOWS Vita Coco tied $45 million to $100 million of the price to an earn-out payable in 2029, so the total depends on results after closing.					
JAN 2026 CONSUMER BRANDS & PRODUCTS	GOJO ACQUIRED BY The Clorox Company	Clorox agreed in January and completed on April 1 the purchase of GOJO Industries, the maker of Purell, family-led in Akron, Ohio since its founding in 1946 (Clorox and GOJO Industries).	$2.25B	Not disclosed	11.9x Adjusted EBITDA net of anticipated tax benefits, as stated by Clorox
WHAT IT SHOWS A family-led brand founded in 1946 sold to a strategic at 11.9x adjusted EBITDA, net of anticipated tax benefits.					

Values and multiples are as stated by the acquirer or reported in the linked source. Value to revenue is our calculation where marked. Company names are the property of their owners and are used for identification. Transactions advised by Benchmark International appear on page 14.

Select Recent Consumer Transactions (Continued)

Health, first-aid, and foodservice transactions, from an $18.7 million brand to a $29.1 billion distributor.

ANNOUNCED	TARGET AND ACQUIRER	BUSINESS AND TERMS	STATED VALUE	VALUE TO REVENUE	VALUE TO EARNINGS
MAR 2026 CONSUMER BRANDS & PRODUCTS	Breathe Right ACQUIRED BY Prestige Consumer Healthcare	Prestige agreed to buy Breathe Right, Dimetapp, and Anbesol from Foundation Consumer Healthcare, brands with about $200 million of 2025 revenue and $95 million of EBITDA, and stated the price as a multiple of EBITDA (Prestige Consumer Healthcare).	**$1.045B**	About 5.2x calculated from the stated figures	**11.0x** EBITDA, as stated by Prestige
WHAT IT SHOWS Brands with $95 million of EBITDA on about $200 million of revenue sold at 5.2x revenue and 11.0x EBITDA, a margin of 47.5%.					
JAN 2026 CONSUMER BRANDS & PRODUCTS	MY MEDIC ACQUIRED BY	Acme United bought My Medic, a maker of first-aid kits sold almost entirely direct to consumers, with about $19 million of revenue (Acme United and My Medic).	**$18.7M**	**About 1.0x** calculated from the stated figures	Not disclosed
WHAT IT SHOWS A first-aid brand sold almost entirely direct to consumers changed hands at about 1.0x revenue.					
MAR 2026 FOODSERVICE & DISTRIBUTION	Where Restaurants Shop ACQUIRED BY Sysco	Sysco agreed to acquire Jetro Restaurant Depot and its 166 cash-and-carry warehouse stores, and it expects to close by the first calendar quarter of 2027 while members of Congress have asked the FTC to investigate (Sysco and Jetro Restaurant Depot).	**About $29.1B** enterprise value	Not disclosed	**14.6x** 2025 operating income, as stated by Sysco
WHAT IT SHOWS At $29.1 billion this is the largest transaction in the table, and members of Congress have asked the FTC to review it.					
MAR 2026 FOODSERVICE & DISTRIBUTION	FEDERAL ACQUIRED BY AERITEK Mill Point Capital	AeriTek bought Federal Industries, a Wisconsin maker of food display cases with $35.7 million of fiscal 2025 revenue, in a carve-out from Standex (Standex on Federal Industries).	**About $70M** enterprise value	**About 2.0x** calculated from the stated figures	Not disclosed
WHAT IT SHOWS A carve-out from a public parent sold at about 2.0x revenue.					

Values and multiples are as stated by the acquirer or reported in the linked source. Value to revenue is our calculation where marked. Company names are the property of their owners and are used for identification. Transactions advised by Benchmark International appear on page 14.

Select Recent Consumer Transactions (Continued)

Buyers in foodservice and consumer services paid for store networks, subscription members, and recurring customer contracts.

ANNOUNCED	TARGET AND ACQUIRER	BUSINESS AND TERMS	STATED VALUE	VALUE TO REVENUE	VALUE TO EARNINGS
APR 2026 FOODSERVICE & DISTRIBUTION	Bresco ACQUIRED BY SINGER	Singer acquired Bresco, a family-led foodservice equipment and supplies dealer in Birmingham, Alabama with $39.3 million of 2025 sales (Singer Equipment and Bresco). Dealer acquirers rarely disclose price.	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	Not disclosed
	WHAT IT SHOWS A dealer bought a dealer, and neither the price nor a multiple was disclosed.				
FEB 2026 CONSUMER SERVICES & RETAIL	Mister ACQUIRED BY LGP | LEONARD GREEN & PARTNERS	Leonard Green agreed in February to take Mister Car Wash private at $7.00 per share and completed the purchase on May 19, when the company had about 550 locations and about 2.5 million subscription members (Mister Car Wash and Leonard Green; Mister Car Wash results).	$3.1B enterprise value	2.9x Calculated from full year 2025 Mister Car Wash financials	9.0x Calculated from full year 2025 Mister Car Wash financials
	WHAT IT SHOWS A sponsor paid 9.0x EBITDA and 2.9x revenue for about 550 locations and 2.5 million subscription members.				
MAR 2026 CONSUMER SERVICES & RETAIL	GUILD GARAGE GROUP ACQUIRED BY OAK HILL CAPITAL	Oak Hill agreed to buy Guild Garage Group, a platform assembled since 2024 from nearly 30 garage door companies and reported to generate revenue above $300 million and EBITDA close to $50 million (Oak Hill and Guild Garage Group), at a price PitchBook put at $800 million and 16 times EBITDA.	$800M as reported	Not disclosed	16x EBITDA, per PitchBook data
	WHAT IT SHOWS A platform assembled from nearly 30 garage door companies since 2024 was priced at 16x EBITDA, against a 7.0x average for middle-market deals.				
APR 2026 CONSUMER SERVICES & RETAIL	ROMEX PEST CONTROL ACQUIRED BY ROLLINS	Rollins acquired Romex Pest Control, a Utah company founded in 2016, and allocated about 89% of the price to customer contracts and goodwill (Rollins and Romex Pest Control; Rollins quarterly filing; PCT Top 100)	$95.7M	2.7x Calculated on 2025 revenue of $35.1M (PCT Top 100)	Not disclosed
	WHAT IT SHOWS Rollins allocated about 89% of the price to customer contracts and goodwill, and the price was 2.7x 2025 revenue.				

Values and multiples are as stated by the acquirer or reported in the linked source. Value to revenue is our calculation where marked. Three transactions are shown for each of the four segments on pages 11 to 13.

Benchmark International's Consumer Transactions

Consumer services and retail is the most active segment, and operating companies and platforms bought just over half of the named companies.

SINCE JANUARY 2025

32

consumer transactions closed in the four segments

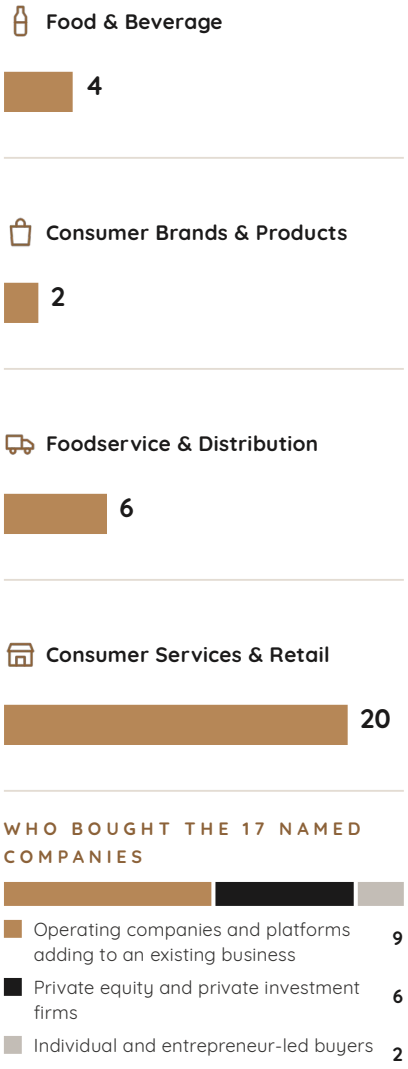
9 of 17

named acquirers were operating companies or platforms adding to an existing business

Ranked the leading privately owned sell-side M&A advisor in the world in PitchBook's Q2 2026 Global League Tables (Benchmark International).

CLOSED BY SEGMENT

Since January 2025



WHO BOUGHT THE 17 NAMED COMPANIES

Operating companies and platforms adding to an existing business	9
Private equity and private investment firms	6
Individual and entrepreneur-led buyers	2

15 MOST RECENT NAMED TRANSACTIONS, BY ANNOUNCEMENT

SEPT 2026

Fire and water damage restoration, Williamsburg, VA

ACQUIRED BY thomasville Restoration

SEPT 2026

Six martial arts academies, New Jersey

ACQUIRED BY ELEVATE YOUTH DEVELOPMENT

JULY 2026

Educational and community outreach materials

ACQUIRED BY HEALTH EDCO

JUNE 2026

Landscape design and installation, Madison, WI area

ACQUIRED BY LANCASTER

JUNE 2026

Landscape construction and maintenance, Fortuna, CA

ACQUIRED BY

MAR 2026

Sales and marketing brokerage for packaged goods

ACQUIRED BY mpg MARKET PERFORMANCE GROUP

MAR 2026

STEPFAR INVESTMENTS LLC

Two collision repair centers, Permian Basin, TX

ACQUIRED BY CLASSIC COLLISION

FEB 2026

Family-owned residential roofing since 1983, Texas

ACQUIRED BY ALLIED

JAN 2026

Contract manufacturer of supplements, Oakdale, CA

ACQUIRED BY

DEC 2025

Customized youth sports apparel, Taunton, MA

ACQUIRED BY INNOVA CAPITAL

DEC 2025

Bulk cooking oil distribution and collection, Ocala, FL

ACQUIRED BY GREASECYCLE

JULY 2025

Garage door sales, installation, and repair, IN and IL

ACQUIRED BY

JUNE 2025

Sports bar and grill restaurant group, Texas

ACQUIRED BY GPC INVESTMENTS INC.

JUNE 2025

Custom pool design and construction, Central Florida

ACQUIRED BY an individual investor

JUNE 2025

Buffet and food presentation equipment, Daphne, AL

ACQUIRED BY

Each tile links to the announcement on benchmarkintl.com, and Benchmark International advised the seller in each. Closed-transaction counts are from Benchmark International's records for January 1, 2025 through September 30, 2026.

Landscape: Select Participants

The listed reference companies in each segment, and the platforms, sponsors, and strategic buyers acquiring founder-owned consumer businesses.

FOOD & BEVERAGE — 20 LISTED

LISTED COMPANIES

ACTIVE PRIVATE AND STRATEGIC BUYERS

CONSUMER BRANDS & PRODUCTS — 12 LISTED

LISTED COMPANIES

ACTIVE PRIVATE AND STRATEGIC BUYERS

FOODSERVICE & DISTRIBUTION — 6 LISTED

LISTED COMPANIES

ACTIVE PRIVATE AND STRATEGIC BUYERS

CONSUMER SERVICES & RETAIL — 18 LISTED

LISTED COMPANIES

ACTIVE PRIVATE AND STRATEGIC BUYERS

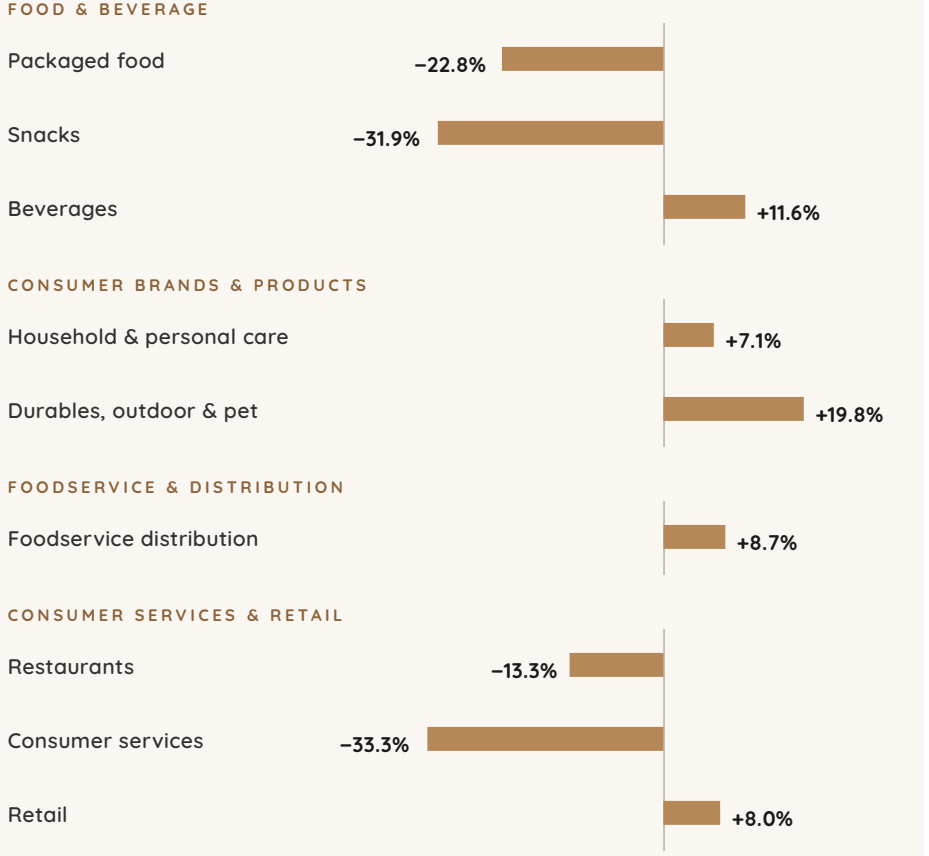
Listed companies are the 56 in the peer groups on pages 21 to 23. Private participants are buyers named in 2026 transactions covered in this report and in announcements of Benchmark International transactions. Company names and marks are the property of their owners and are shown for identification.

Public Company Market Performance

Packaged food and snack shares are down a quarter to a third in a year, and earnings rose most at consumer services and foodservice companies.

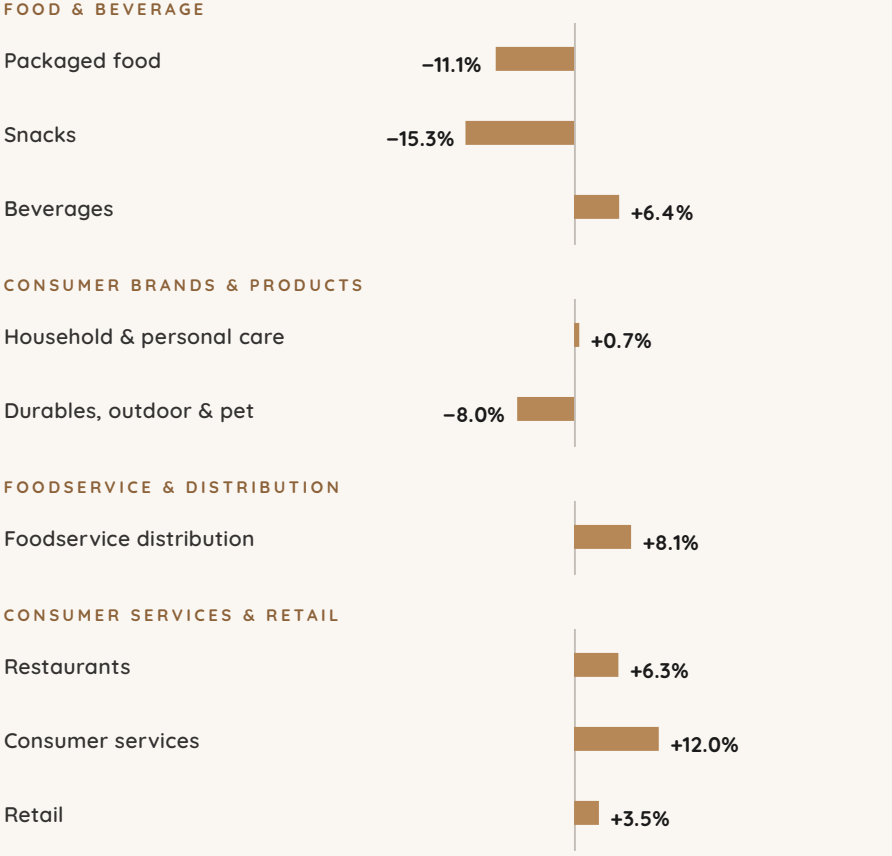
Median change in share price over 52 weeks

Share prices dated October 14 to October 19, 2026, against a year earlier



Median change in EBITDA, latest fiscal year

Reported EBITDA for the latest fiscal year against the year before



WHAT THE MARKET IS PRICING

31 of 56
listed consumer companies trade below their share price of a year ago

12.0x
median enterprise value to trailing EBITDA today, against 14.2x a year ago

7 of 9
peer groups carry a lower median multiple of EBITDA than a year ago

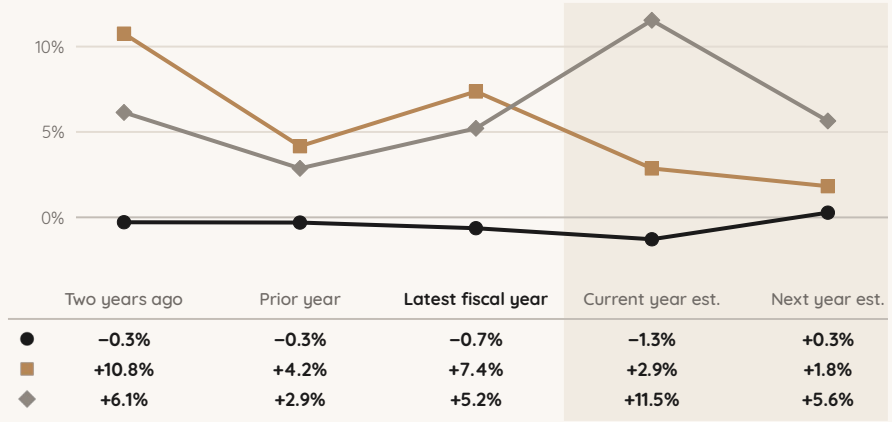
Medians of 56 listed companies in nine peer groups, listed on pages 21 to 23. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026. EBITDA is as reported, so the snack and packaged food declines include commodity hedging and impairment charges. The snacks median sits between Hershey, down 10%, and three smaller companies down 54% to 79%. Multiples cover the 52 companies with comparable readings on both dates; foodservice distribution is unchanged and household and personal care is higher.

Revenue Growth Trends

Snack, restaurant, and consumer services companies grew fastest in their latest fiscal year, and packaged food revenue has declined three years running.

Food & Beverage

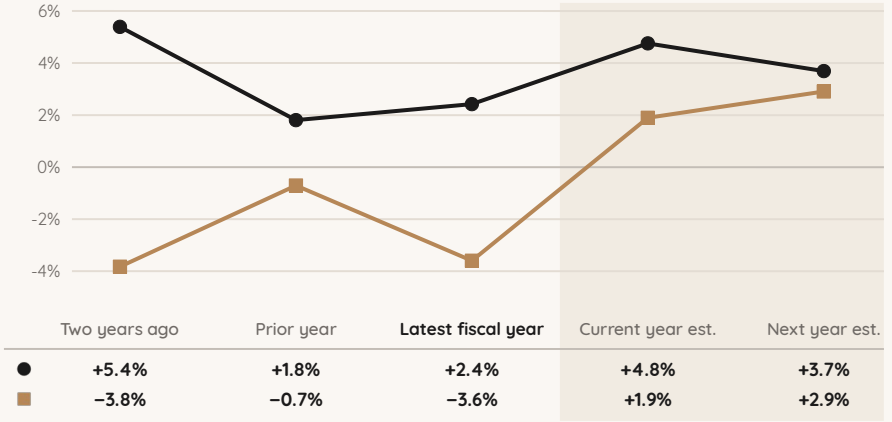
Median revenue growth of the listed peer group, by fiscal year



	Two years ago	Prior year	Latest fiscal year	Current year est.	Next year est.
●	−0.3%	−0.3%	−0.7%	−1.3%	+0.3%
■	+10.8%	+4.2%	+7.4%	+2.9%	+1.8%
◆	+6.1%	+2.9%	+5.2%	+11.5%	+5.6%

Consumer Brands & Products

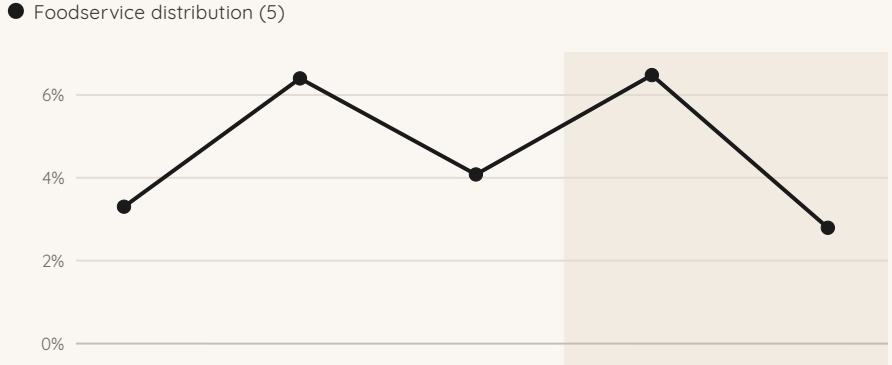
Median revenue growth of the listed peer group, by fiscal year



	Two years ago	Prior year	Latest fiscal year	Current year est.	Next year est.
●	+5.4%	+1.8%	+2.4%	+4.8%	+3.7%
■	−3.8%	−0.7%	−3.6%	+1.9%	+2.9%

Foodservice & Distribution

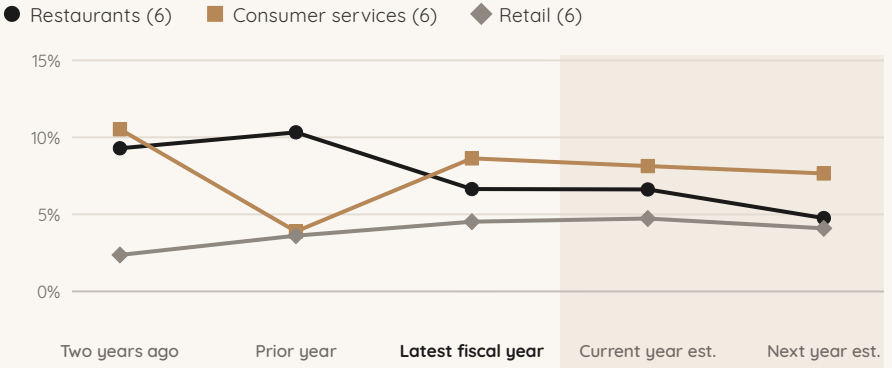
Median revenue growth of the listed peer group, by fiscal year



	Two years ago	Prior year	Latest fiscal year	Current year est.	Next year est.
●	+3.3%	+6.4%	+4.1%	+6.5%	+2.8%

Consumer Services & Retail

Median revenue growth of the listed peer group, by fiscal year



	Two years ago	Prior year	Latest fiscal year	Current year est.	Next year est.
●	+9.3%	+10.3%	+6.6%	+6.6%	+4.8%
■	+10.5%	+3.9%	+8.6%	+8.1%	+7.7%
◆	+2.4%	+3.6%	+4.5%	+4.7%	+4.1%

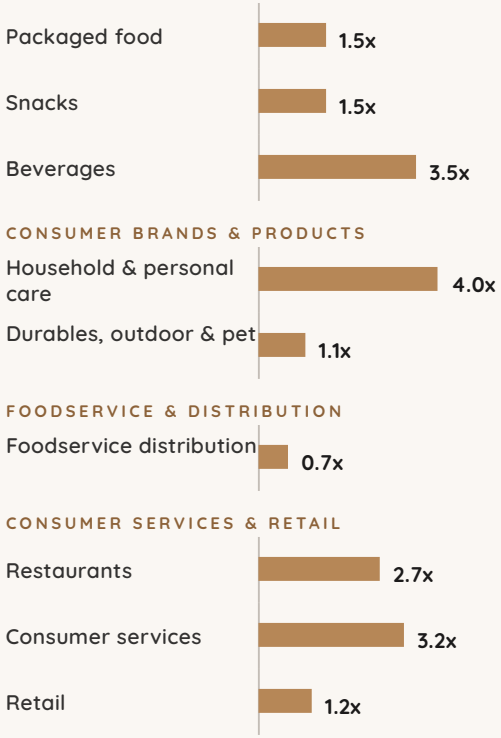
Medians of fiscal-year revenue growth, including acquisitions, with the number of companies in brackets. Shaded years are analyst consensus; current-year estimates are as retrieved October 19, 2026 and next-year estimates as retrieved October 7. Beverage estimates carry Keurig Dr Pepper's JDE Peet's purchase and Celsius's Alani Nu purchase. Middleby is left out because its revenue was restated for a spin-off. Source: StockAnalysis.

Public Company Valuation Metrics

The median multiple of EBITDA is lower than a year ago in seven of nine peer groups and below its three-year median in eight of nine.

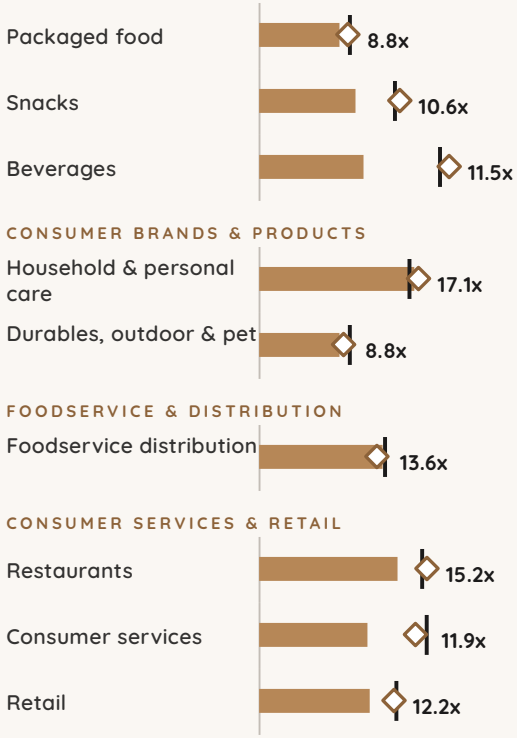
Median enterprise value to revenue

Trailing twelve months



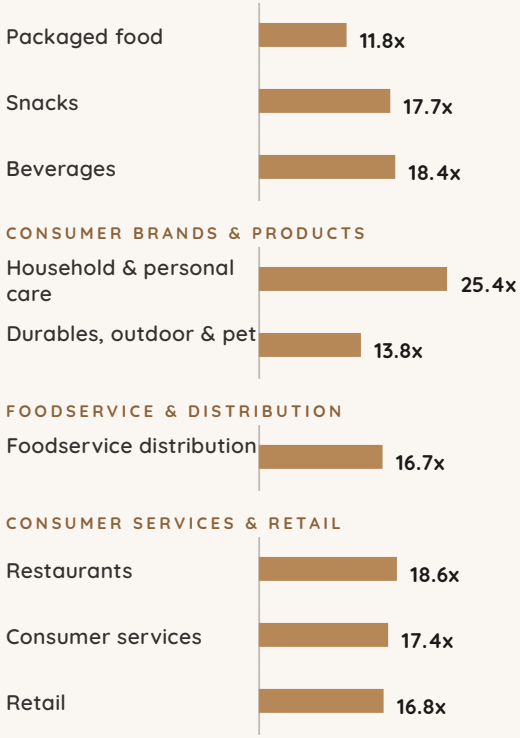
Median enterprise value to EBITDA

Trailing twelve months. | A year ago ◇ Three-year median



Median forward price to earnings

Share price to consensus earnings for the next year



DEAL MULTIPLES, LARGE AND MIDDLE MARKET

12.5x median EV to EBITDA on US buyouts closed in 2025 (PitchBook)

7.0x average EBITDA multiple, GF Data middle-market deals, Q2 2026 (Mercer)

14.3x trailing adjusted EBITDA: Kimberly-Clark for Kenvue

10.7x CY2026 adjusted EBITDA: Hormel for Brakebush Brothers

5.0x 2025 adjusted EBITDA on the base price: HF Foods for Searay Foods

BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL

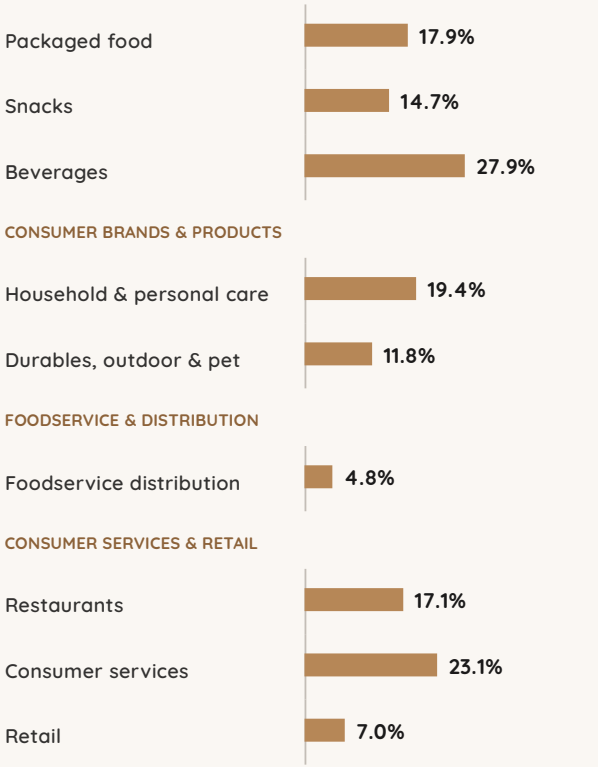
Medians by peer group, which can move with one or two companies in a group of six. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026. Multiples use reported EBITDA. The year-ago multiple is the reading at the quarter-end nearest September 30, 2025. The three-year median is the median of each company's multiple at its fiscal quarter-ends since October 2023, for the companies with a reading today and a year ago. The PitchBook median covers US buyouts closed in 2025; the GF Data average covers 85 reported deals of $10 million to $500 million enterprise value in the second quarter of 2026. Acquirer multiples are as stated by each acquirer on its own basis.

Operating Metrics

Beverage companies keep the highest EBITDA and free cash flow margins, and foodservice distribution and retail run on the thinnest margins.

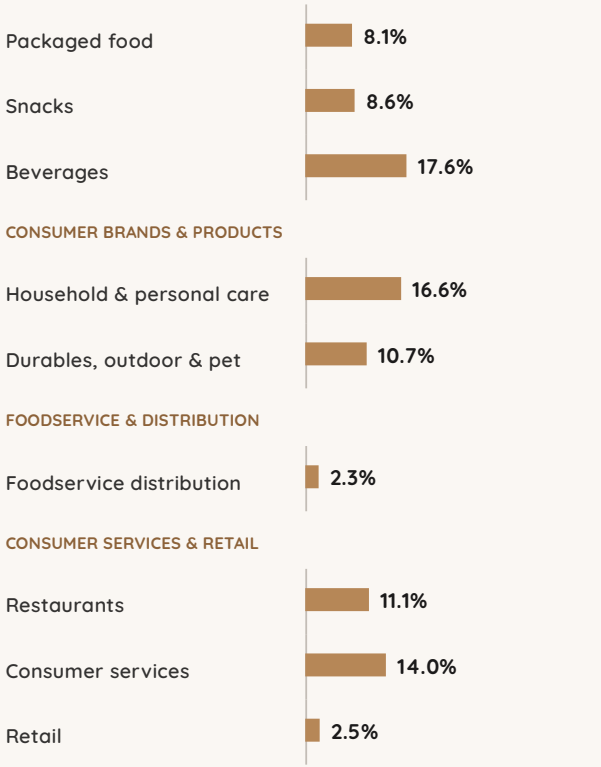
Median EBITDA margin

Trailing twelve months, by peer group



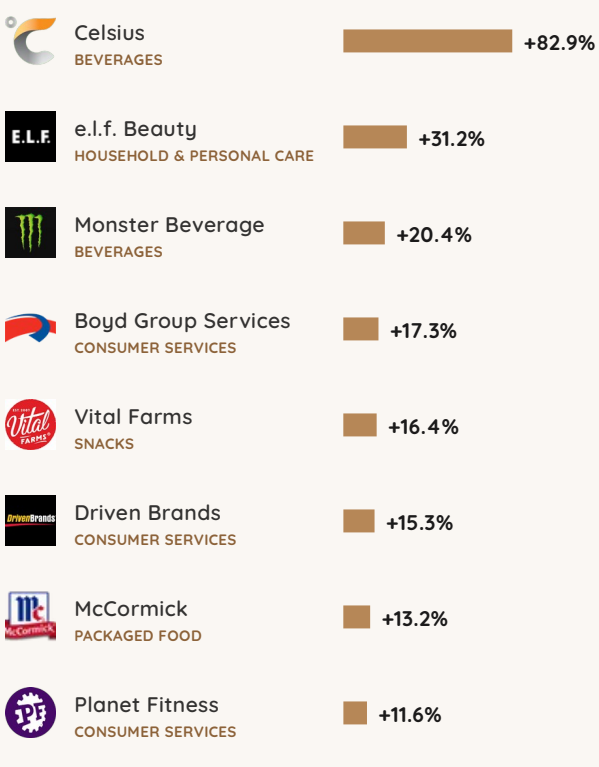
Median free cash flow margin

Trailing twelve months, by peer group



Fastest revenue growth

Trailing twelve months, 56 listed companies



WHAT THE MARGINS SHOW

15.8%
median EBITDA margin of the listed consumer companies

9.6%
median free cash flow margin of the listed consumer companies

28 of 54
listed consumer companies grew revenue more than 5% over the trailing twelve months

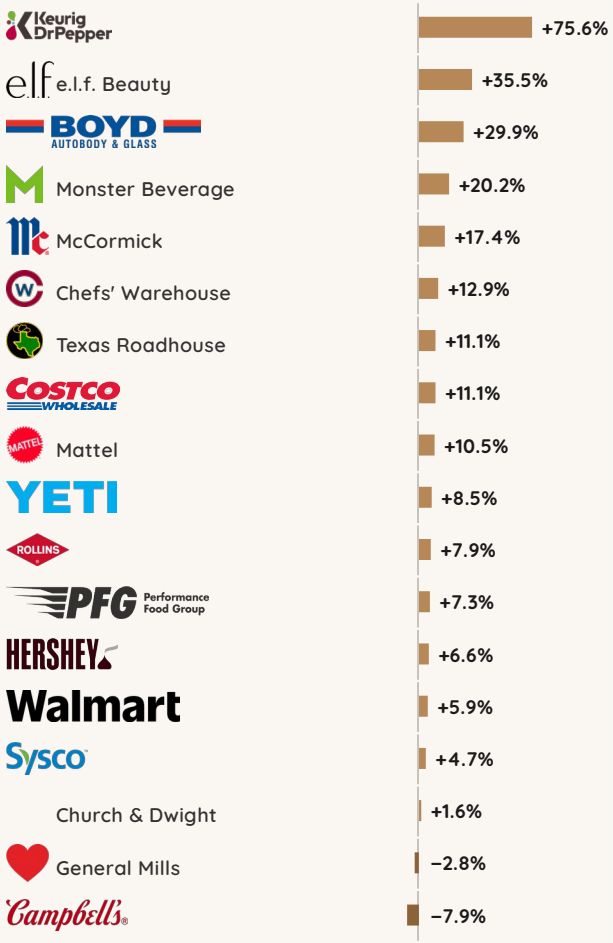
Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026. Margins are trailing twelve months as reported, and medians exclude companies without a reading (Vital Farms for free cash flow margin). Revenue growth compares the trailing twelve months with the prior twelve and includes acquisitions.

Earnings and Commentary

Beverage, beauty, and platform companies grew fastest in their latest quarter, while General Mills and Campbell's reported lower sales.

Net sales growth, latest quarter

Year over year, as reported; selected companies



BRANDS AND PRICING

"We delivered a strong first half, with reported net sales up 8.7%, organic net sales up 5.8% and meaningful earnings recovery."

Kirk Tanner, President and Chief Executive Officer, The Hershey Company

"Our power brands continued to perform exceptionally well in a challenging macroeconomic environment, driving a second straight quarter of industry-leading organic sales growth."

Rick Dierker, Chief Executive Officer, Church & Dwight

READ-THROUGH

Hershey's second-quarter organic sales rose 3.6% on about 12 points of price against an 8-point volume decline, and Church & Dwight grew volume 4.3%, so buyers look at units before price.

CHANNELS AND PORTFOLIOS

"We also saw continued progress across our omni-channel model, including strong wholesale sell-through, healthy DTC demand and improving trends in Corporate Sales."

Matt Reintjes, Chair of the Board and Chief Executive Officer, YETI

"We remain confident in the strategic benefits of the proposed combination with Unilever Foods and have made substantial progress on integration planning."

Brendan M. Foley, Chairman, President, and CEO, McCormick

READ-THROUGH

Keurig Dr Pepper's growth includes JDE Peet's, YETI grew wholesale sales 10% and direct-to-consumer sales 7%, and McCormick is planning its Unilever Foods combination, so buyers separate acquired from organic growth.

PLATFORMS AND DISTRIBUTION

"We also successfully completed the conversion of Joe Hudson's 258 locations during the quarter, accelerating synergy realization, which contributed to the strength in our profitability."

Brian Kaner, President & CEO, Boyd Group

"We have clear positive momentum in our business domestically and internationally."

Kevin Hourican, Chair of the Board and Chief Executive Officer, Sysco

READ-THROUGH

Boyd's sales rose 29.9%, mostly from new locations that include 258 Joe Hudson's centers, and Sysco reported positive case growth across its local, national, and international businesses.

Growth is net sales as reported for each company's latest quarter, ended May to September 2026 (StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026), and includes acquisitions, divestitures, and currency; Keurig Dr Pepper includes JDE Peet's. Organic growth for Hershey and Church & Dwight is on page 5. Quotations are from each company's earnings release.

Public Company Metrics: Food and Beverage

Packaged food companies trade at a median 8.8 times EBITDA. Keurig Dr Pepper's figures include JDE Peet's, and Utz has agreed to be acquired by Intersnack.

COMPANY	TICKER	MARKET CAP ($B)	ENTERPRISE VALUE ($B)	SHARE PRICE, 52 WEEKS	EV / REVENUE	EV / EBITDA TODAY	EV / EBITDA A YEAR AGO	FORWARD P/E	REVENUE GROWTH, TRAILING	EBITDA MARGIN	REVENUE GROWTH, CURRENT YEAR EST.
PACKAGED FOOD											
General Mills	GIS	17.7	30.9	–30.6%	1.69x	9.1x	11.1x	10.7x	–4.5%	18.7%	–4.0%
Conagra Brands	CAG	6.9	14.3	–21.1%	1.27x	8.6x	8.9x	10.1x	–1.8%	14.7%	–4.0%
Kraft Heinz	KHC	28.1	44.4	–6.0%	1.78x	8.1x	8.3x	11.9x	–1.6%	22.1%	–1.3%
Campbell's	CPB	5.9	13.0	–34.1%	1.33x	8.0x	8.8x	11.7x	–5.0%	16.6%	–2.5%
J.M. Smucker	SJM	13.6	20.5	+23.1%	2.24x	9.1x	10.6x	12.6x	+5.1%	24.7%	–1.3%
Hormel Foods	HRL	11.2	13.2	–13.7%	1.09x	10.4x	12.5x	13.3x	+0.7%	10.4%	+0.2%
McCormick	MKC	12.5	17.2	–29.0%	2.23x	11.4x	18.0x	15.0x	+13.2%	19.6%	+15.8%
Post Holdings	POST	3.5	10.8	–24.5%	1.29x	7.5x	8.8x	11.1x	+6.2%	17.2%	+0.2%
Median				**–22.8%**	**1.51x**	**8.8x**	**9.8x**	**11.8x**	**–0.5%**	**17.9%**	**–1.3%**
SNACKS AND BETTER-FOR-YOU											
Mondelez	MDLZ	81.6	101.9	+3.6%	2.57x	16.8x	17.7x	19.9x	+6.9%	15.3%	+4.1%
Hershey	HSY	33.8	38.9	–9.6%	3.24x	14.5x	17.6x	18.3x	+7.7%	22.4%	+5.0%
Utz Brands	UTZ	2.1	3.0	+16.2%	2.09x	33.4x	n.m.	17.7x	+1.9%	6.2%	+3.7%
BellRing Brands	BRBR	1.1	2.2	–72.7%	0.94x	6.7x	10.8x	7.8x	+5.9%	14.1%	+2.0%
Simply Good Foods	SMPL	0.99	1.3	–54.1%	0.94x	6.0x	11.8x	6.8x	–4.5%	15.6%	–6.9%
Vital Farms	VITL	0.36	0.45	–78.6%	0.58x	n.m.	n.m.	n.a.	+16.4%	2.0%	+0.9%
Median				**–31.9%**	**1.51x**	**10.6x**	**14.7x**	**17.7x**	**+6.4%**	**14.7%**	**+2.9%**
BEVERAGES											
Coca-Cola	KO	401.8	429.7	+36.9%	8.62x	25.4x	19.6x	27.5x	+6.5%	33.9%	+3.9%
PepsiCo	PEP	179.2	219.9	–13.0%	2.24x	11.5x	13.9x	15.5x	+6.4%	19.5%	+5.7%
Keurig Dr Pepper	KDP	47.1	79.1	+28.6%	n.m.	n.m.	12.3x	14.3x	n.m.	23.9%	+58.5%
Monster Beverage	MNST	89.6	86.3	+33.2%	9.36x	29.4x	25.6x	37.1x	+20.4%	31.8%	+17.4%
Celsius	CELH	7.3	7.4	–56.0%	2.36x	10.7x	39.5x	21.2x	+82.9%	22.0%	+26.1%
Constellation Brands	STZ	22.2	32.4	–5.4%	3.52x	9.5x	11.1x	11.0x	–4.3%	37.2%	–0.2%
Median				**+11.6%**	**3.52x**	**11.5x**	**19.6x**	**18.4x**	**+6.5%**	**27.9%**	**+11.5%**

Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026; share prices are dated October 14 to 19. Multiples and margins use reported trailing EBITDA, and EBITDA growth compares the latest completed fiscal year with the year before. n.m. marks a figure that is not comparable and is left out of the median; n.a. is not available. Year-ago multiples are the reading at the quarter-end nearest September 30, 2025, and multiple medians use companies with both readings.

Public Company Metrics: Consumer Brands and Foodservice

Household and personal care companies hold the highest multiples of the nine groups. Middleby's figures follow the July spin-off of its food processing business.

COMPANY	TICKER	MARKET CAP ($B)	ENTERPRISE VALUE ($B)	SHARE PRICE, 52 WEEKS	EV / REVENUE	EV / EBITDA TODAY	EV / EBITDA A YEAR AGO	FORWARD P/E	REVENUE GROWTH, TRAILING	EBITDA MARGIN	REVENUE GROWTH, CURRENT YEAR EST.
HOUSEHOLD AND PERSONAL CARE											
Procter & Gamble	PG	366.7	391.8	+4.5%	4.54x	16.0x	15.7x	22.8x	+3.3%	28.4%	+2.1%
Colgate-Palmolive	CL	75.0	81.4	+21.2%	3.87x	16.3x	15.0x	24.1x	+5.2%	23.7%	+5.0%
Church & Dwight	CHD	24.8	27.0	+21.0%	4.33x	19.9x	16.9x	26.6x	+2.7%	21.8%	+0.6%
Clorox	CLX	10.4	15.8	–28.4%	2.38x	14.0x	14.5x	15.3x	–5.4%	17.0%	+13.6%
Estee Lauder	EL	37.8	43.6	+9.7%	2.90x	17.8x	18.4x	31.4x	+5.0%	16.3%	+4.5%
e.l.f. Beauty	ELF	6.7	7.3	–15.3%	4.13x	34.8x	44.7x	37.2x	+31.2%	11.9%	+20.7%
Median				**+7.1%**	**4.00x**	**17.1x**	**16.3x**	**25.4x**	**+4.2%**	**19.4%**	**+4.8%**
DURABLES, OUTDOOR AND PET											
Central Garden & Pet	CENT	2.6	3.0	+44.5%	0.98x	9.0x	7.5x	14.6x	–1.2%	11.0%	–3.7%
Spectrum Brands	SPB	1.8	2.3	+54.6%	0.81x	8.3x	8.0x	14.8x	+0.8%	9.8%	+2.0%
YETI	YETI	3.1	3.3	+28.1%	1.72x	11.4x	10.0x	13.8x	+6.2%	15.1%	+7.6%
Mattel	MAT	4.9	7.1	–3.7%	1.30x	10.9x	9.4x	13.1x	+2.9%	11.9%	+6.0%
Newell Brands	NWL	2.4	7.9	+11.5%	1.09x	8.7x	10.1x	8.6x	–2.0%	12.5%	+1.8%
Traeger	COOK	0.12	0.48	–16.3%	1.00x	8.7x	11.0x	n.m.	–15.3%	11.6%	–20.2%
Median				**+19.8%**	**1.05x**	**8.8x**	**9.7x**	**13.8x**	**–0.2%**	**11.7%**	**+1.9%**
FOODSERVICE DISTRIBUTION AND EQUIPMENT											
Sysco	SYY	40.1	53.3	+2.7%	0.64x	11.9x	12.1x	16.1x	+3.9%	5.3%	+6.5%
US Foods	USFD	22.1	27.4	+32.1%	0.68x	15.4x	13.6x	19.6x	+3.8%	4.4%	+5.3%
Performance Food Group	PFGC	15.4	23.1	–5.6%	0.36x	13.6x	15.3x	17.2x	+7.2%	2.6%	+13.0%
Chefs' Warehouse	CHEF	4.6	5.4	+97.9%	1.24x	20.8x	14.8x	41.1x	+11.2%	5.9%	+10.4%
United Natural Foods	UNFI	2.9	5.9	+14.8%	0.19x	9.4x	10.9x	14.1x	–2.0%	2.0%	+1.2%
Middleby	MIDD	4.9	6.7	–19.4%	1.98x	9.6x	n.m.	14.8x	n.m.	20.7%	n.m.
Median				**+8.7%**	**0.66x**	**13.6x**	**13.6x**	**16.7x**	**+3.9%**	**4.9%**	**+6.5%**

Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026; share prices are dated October 14 to 19. Multiples and margins use reported trailing EBITDA, and EBITDA growth compares the latest completed fiscal year with the year before. n.m. marks a figure that is not comparable and is left out of the median; n.a. is not available. Year-ago multiples are the reading at the quarter-end nearest September 30, 2025, and multiple medians use companies with both readings.

Public Company Metrics: Restaurants, Services, and Retail

Rollins, Planet Fitness, and Boyd Group shares fell more than 40% in a year while their revenue kept growing.

COMPANY	TICKER	MARKET CAP ($B)	ENTERPRISE VALUE ($B)	SHARE PRICE, 52 WEEKS	EV / REVENUE	EV / EBITDA TODAY	EV / EBITDA A YEAR AGO	FORWARD P/E	REVENUE GROWTH, TRAILING	EBITDA MARGIN	REVENUE GROWTH, CURRENT YEAR EST.
RESTAURANTS											
Darden Restaurants	DRI	24.4	32.8	+14.5%	2.46x	15.3x	16.3x	18.8x	+8.1%	16.0%	+3.7%
Texas Roadhouse	TXRH	11.1	12.0	–5.1%	1.92x	16.9x	16.4x	23.9x	+9.9%	11.3%	+11.1%
Chipotle	CMG	37.4	42.1	–29.3%	3.40x	18.6x	24.0x	23.6x	+7.3%	18.3%	+9.2%
McDonald's	MCD	171.8	225.5	–21.4%	8.15x	15.1x	18.9x	18.4x	+6.3%	53.9%	+4.7%
Domino's Pizza	DPZ	10.0	14.9	–27.1%	2.97x	14.4x	20.6x	14.8x	+4.5%	20.6%	+5.0%
Brinker International	EAT	8.2	9.9	+54.5%	1.75x	12.0x	9.6x	14.8x	+7.9%	14.6%	+8.2%
Median				**–13.3%**	**2.71x**	**15.2x**	**17.7x**	**18.6x**	**+7.6%**	**17.2%**	**+6.6%**
CONSUMER AND ROUTE-BASED SERVICES											
Rollins	ROL	15.6	16.6	–41.6%	4.25x	19.3x	34.8x	27.9x	+9.9%	22.1%	+8.6%
Frontdoor	FTDR	5.5	6.1	+21.1%	2.80x	11.6x	11.4x	16.5x	+9.2%	24.0%	+5.1%
Driven Brands	DRVN	1.9	4.0	–25.0%	2.06x	9.8x	16.0x	9.2x	+15.3%	21.0%	+7.7%
Planet Fitness	PLNT	3.9	6.4	–45.5%	4.93x	11.1x	20.3x	14.9x	+11.6%	44.4%	+15.0%
Service Corporation Intl	SCI	11.1	16.1	–1.5%	3.69x	12.2x	12.5x	18.3x	+2.9%	30.3%	+3.6%
Boyd Group Services	BGSI	2.2	4.2	–45.6%	1.19x	13.9x	21.3x	20.4x	+17.3%	8.5%	+29.5%
Median				**–33.3%**	**3.25x**	**11.9x**	**18.2x**	**17.4x**	**+10.8%**	**23.1%**	**+8.1%**
RETAIL											
Walmart	WMT	941.4	1,005.0	+10.2%	1.37x	22.8x	20.1x	39.5x	+6.2%	6.0%	+5.6%
Costco	COST	440.6	429.5	+5.9%	1.41x	30.2x	32.1x	43.4x	+10.1%	4.7%	+8.7%
Target	TGT	69.7	83.5	+69.3%	0.78x	9.7x	7.2x	16.5x	+2.0%	8.0%	+5.2%
Kroger	KR	37.1	59.6	–9.1%	0.40x	7.4x	7.9x	11.9x	+1.6%	5.4%	+2.1%
Dollar General	DG	29.2	43.4	+25.2%	1.00x	12.2x	11.8x	16.8x	+4.8%	8.2%	+4.3%
Tractor Supply	TSCO	17.2	23.5	–40.6%	1.48x	12.1x	17.9x	16.8x	+4.0%	12.3%	+2.8%
Median				**+8.0%**	**1.19x**	**12.2x**	**14.9x**	**16.8x**	**+4.4%**	**7.0%**	**+4.7%**

Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026; share prices are dated October 14 to 19. Multiples and margins use reported trailing EBITDA, and EBITDA growth compares the latest completed fiscal year with the year before. n.m. marks a figure that is not comparable and is left out of the median; n.a. is not available. Year-ago multiples are the reading at the quarter-end nearest September 30, 2025, and multiple medians use companies with both readings.

Demand and Cost Indicators

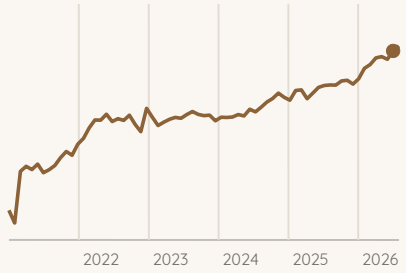
Spending is rising in dollars while sentiment falls, food manufacturers' selling prices sit below a year ago, and diesel costs two thirds more than a year ago.

Retail and food services sales

Monthly, seasonally adjusted, US Census Bureau

$745.0B
Sep 2026

+6.3%
over one year



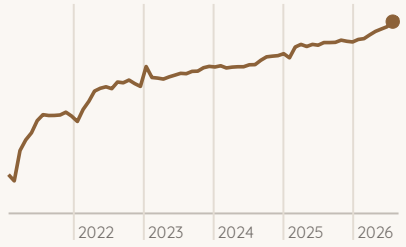
Source: FRED, series RSAFS; Census advance release

Food services and drinking places sales

Monthly, seasonally adjusted, US Census Bureau

$92.9B
Sep 2026

+7.0%
over one year



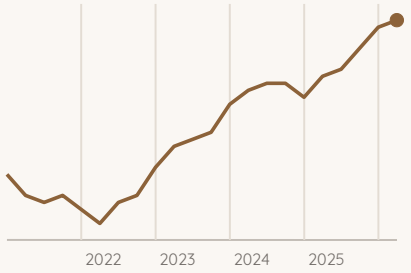
Source: FRED, series RSFSDP; Census advance release

E-commerce share of retail sales

Quarterly, seasonally adjusted, US Census Bureau

17.1%
Q2 2026

+0.8 pts
over one year



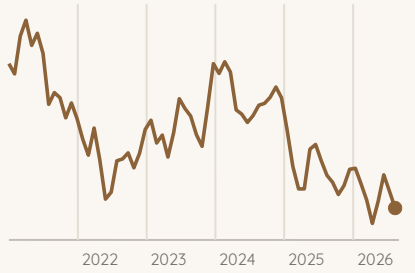
Source: FRED, series ECOMPCTSA

Consumer sentiment

University of Michigan index, monthly

48.1
Sep 2026

–7.0 pts
over one year



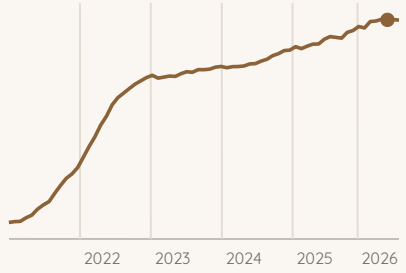
Source: FRED, series UMCSENT; Surveys of Consumers

Food at home prices

Consumer price index, seasonally adjusted, 1982-84 = 100

321.1
Sep 2026

+1.8%
over one year



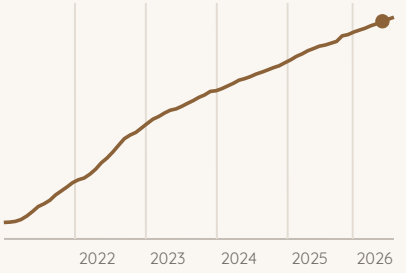
Source: FRED, series CUSR0000SAF11

Food away from home prices

Consumer price index, seasonally adjusted, 1982-84 = 100

398.8
Sep 2026

+3.5%
over one year



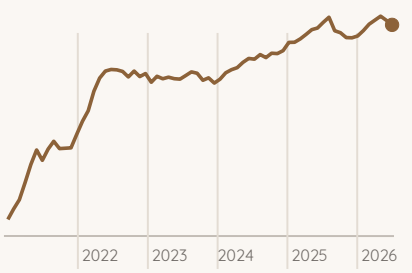
Source: FRED, series CUSR0000SEFV

Food manufacturing producer prices

Producer price index, Dec 1984 = 100, Bureau of Labor Statistics

271.8
Sep 2026

–1.0%
over one year



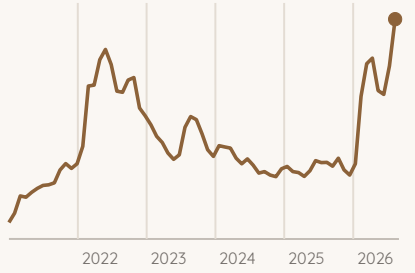
Source: FRED, series PCU311311

Diesel price

US on-highway retail price per gallon, monthly average

$6.29
Sep 2026

+67.8%
over one year



Source: FRED, series GASDESM

Each series runs from January 2021. September retail figures are the Census advance estimate on the series as revised October 15, 2026, and September sentiment is the final reading from the Surveys of Consumers. The consumer price series have no October 2025 reading because that month's index was not produced during the federal shutdown; the unadjusted food-at-home increase for September is 1.9%.

03

About Benchmark

Benchmark International's Middle Market team represents owners of privately held companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value in strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions. The first step is a confidential conversation about your goals, your company, and your options, with no pressure and no commitment.

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Benchmark International advises owners of privately held companies around the world, and its Middle Market team represents owners of companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value in strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions. The first step is a confidential conversation about your goals, your company, and your options.

#1

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15

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Listed-company figures are from StockAnalysis and use reported results. Index series are from FRED, the US Census Bureau, the Bureau of Labor Statistics, and the University of Michigan. Benchmark International figures are from the firm's transaction records as of October 1, 2026. Earnings quotations are from each company's earnings release, and the view on page 8 is the Middle Market team's.